

Active Oahu Tours - Ella's Linear Workflow Guide

Active Oahu Tours — Ella's Linear Workflow Guide

Welcome aboard, Ella! ☺

Aloha and welcome to Active Oahu Tours. We're genuinely excited to have you. You're joining a small, focused team doing something pretty unusual: pairing human creativity and local judgment with AI that handles the grunt work. The AI is fast and tireless, but it can't tell if something *feels* right, *sounds* like a real person, or captures the spirit of this place. That's where you come in.

This guide walks through how you'll work with **Linear** (our task management system) and **Hermes** (the AI agent that assigns your work), plus what your human-in-the-loop role actually looks like day to day.

1. Who You Are in This System

You're one of two humans steering the AI — you and Michael. Here's what makes your role genuinely irreplaceable:

- **Quality verification** — The AI generates drafts, outlines, and transcriptions. You read them with human eyes. You catch what sounds corporate, what feels off-brand, and what misses the local magic.
- **Content writing** — Blog posts, tour descriptions, email newsletters, FAQ pages. The AI gives you raw material; you turn it into something people actually want to read.
- **Interview transcription review** — Michael records himself answering interview questions (like he's telling a friend about Kāne'ohe Bay). The swarm transcribes it. You polish the raw text, remove filler words, organize thoughts, and shape it into crisp, readable pages.
- **Creative judgment** — The AI doesn't know if a sentence *sings*. You do. If a paragraph feels flat, you'll know. If a description would make someone book a kayak tour, you'll feel that too.
- **Local knowledge building** — You're new to Oahu, and that's fine. As you learn — about tides, geography, Hawaiian culture, practical details — you'll catch AI mistakes that only someone building real local knowledge would spot.

In short: the AI handles volume and draft quality. You handle taste, accuracy, and voice.

2. How Linear Works

Linear is where all your tasks live. Think of it as your work inbox — Hermes drops assignments there, and you work through them.

2.1 The Anatomy of a Linear Task

Every task has:

Field	What it means
Title	What you need to do (e.g., “Write blog post: Why Kailua Beats Waikiki for Kayaking”)
Description	Instructions, context, examples, relevant links, and anything Hermes thinks you’ll need
Status	Where the task is in the pipeline
Priority	How urgent it is

2.2 Task Statuses

Todo → In Progress → In Review → Done

- **Todo** — Waiting for you. These are your queued-up assignments from Hermes.
- **In Progress** — You’re actively working on this one. Only pick up what you can handle.
- **In Review** — You’ve finished your part. Michael or Hermes will review next.
- **Done** — Reviewed, approved, shipped.

2.3 Priority Levels

Priority	Meaning	Example
P0 🚨	Urgent — drop everything	Site is broken, booking page has wrong info
P1 🚦	High — do this week	Customer-facing page needs updating before peak season
P2 📅	Normal — your standard pace	Blog post, tour description draft
P3 📝	Low — when you have bandwidth	Backlog ideas, nice-to-have improvements
P4 📁	Backlog — someday	Brainstormed topics, seasonal content for next year

P0 and P1 are rare. Most of your work will be P2, with occasional P3 fillers.

2.4 Where to Find Linear

Go to [linear.app](#) and log in with the account Michael sets up for you. Bookmark it. It’s the first thing you check every work session.

3. Ella's Day-to-Day Workflow

Here's the rhythm Hermes is designed around:

Step 1: Check Linear (Start of Session)

Open Linear. See what's in your **Todo** column. Hermes keeps your batch at **3-5 active tasks** — never a firehose, never empty.

Step 2: Pick Up a Task

Choose one task from Todo. Move it to **In Progress**. Read the description carefully — Hermes includes context, examples, and links so you're never starting from scratch.

Step 3: Do the Work

Write, revise, polish. The AI will have given you a starting point in most cases (a draft, an outline, a transcribed interview). Your job is to make it *good* — accurate, warm, specific, and distinctly Active Oahu.

Step 4: Move to In Review

When you're satisfied, move the task to **In Review**. Michael or Hermes will take a look. If there are notes, you'll see them as comments on the task.

Step 5: Hermes Assigns the Next Batch

When most of your current batch is in Review or Done, Hermes automatically assigns your next set of 3-5 tasks. No chasing anyone down — work just appears when you're ready for it.

Communication Tips

- **Questions about a task?** Comment directly on the Linear issue. Hermes monitors these.
- **Need Michael's input?** Slack or Discord for quick questions. Async is preferred — leave a message and he'll respond (remember, Hawaii is 2 hours behind Mountain Time).
- **Voice calls with Michael?** Available when needed, but most day-to-day stuff works better async.
- **Confused about something in a task?** Just ask in a Linear comment. Hermes will clarify or reassign if needed.

4. The Interview Pipeline (Your Part)

This is one of the coolest things we do — and a big reason your role matters.

Here's how authentic, local content gets made without anyone spending weeks on it:

1. Hermes writes interview scripts
↓
(20–35 specific questions per topic)
2. Michael records audio answers
↓
(natural, conversational – like telling a friend)
3. Swarm transcribes and extracts quotes/stories/facts
↓
4. ☐ ELLA reviews the transcription ☐
↓
(polish raw text, remove filler, organize thoughts)
5. ☐ ELLA writes the web pages ☐
↓
(based on Michael's answers + your own research)
6. Hermes generates schema markup and SEO
↓
7. ☐ ELLA final-proofs the pages ☐

You touch three critical stages — transcription review, page writing, and final proofing. The AI does the mechanical work; you do the human work.

Interview Scripts Ready for Michael to Record

These are the scripts Hermes has already prepared. Familiarize yourself with them early so you know what content is coming:

- **Kualoa & Chinaman’s Hat** (25 questions) — GRO-340
- **Kāne’ohe Bay & Sandbar** (20 questions) — GRO-341
- **North Shore & Sharks Cove** (20 questions) — GRO-342
- **Kailua & Lanikai** — GRO-343
- **Brand Origin Story** — GRO-344
- **Windward Hidden Oahu** — GRO-345

Reading these scripts before you start the corresponding pages means you’ll know exactly what Michael said (and can spot when the AI misinterprets something).

5. Content Types & Turnaround Times

Here’s what you’ll be writing, and how fast we’re aiming:

Content Type	Turnaround	Notes
Blog posts	2–3 days	Tour guides, comparison pieces, local tips, safety guides
Tour description pages	1–2 days	Updating activity pages with fresh, specific detail
Tide & safety guides	1–2 days	Practical info customers actually need
FAQ pages	1–2 days	Real customer questions, answered clearly

Email newsletters	2-3 days	Monthly updates, seasonal content, stories
Social media posts	1 day	Short-form from blog material

These aren't rigid deadlines — they're rhythms. Some pieces take longer because they need more research or polish. That's fine. Just keep things moving.

6. The Tools You'll Use

Tool	Purpose	Notes
Linear (linear.app)	Task management	Your work inbox — check it first.
Google Docs	Drafting content	Write here, share for review if needed.
Google Drive	Shared brand assets	Photos, logos, style guides, competitor research.
FareHarbor	Tour booking dashboard	For accurate tour names, prices, durations, availability.
Canva	Social media graphics	Templates are provided — you're not designing from scratch.
Slack or Discord	Team communication	Async chat, shared channels.

7. Quality Standards — What “Good” Looks Like

This is the soul of the job. The AI can write grammatically perfect text. It cannot do this:

Brand Voice

- **Friendly, local, knowledgeable.** Like a surf instructor telling you where the best break is — not a travel agency brochure.
- **Never corporate.** If it sounds like it came from a Marriott website, rewrite it.
- **Never AI-sounding.** If it feels flat, generic, or oddly formal, it probably is. You'll learn to spot this fast.
- **Specific beats generic, every time.**

□ “The sandbar is a popular attraction for tourists visiting the area.”

□ “The sandbar appears about three hours after low tide at Kāneʻohe Bay. Paddle out from Heʻeia Kea Boat Harbor, and by the time you arrive it’s a football field of ankle-deep water in the middle of the bay.”

Hawaiian Cultural Respect

- Use correct **diacritical marks** where appropriate: the **ʻokina** (‘ — like an apostrophe, marking a glottal stop) and the **kahakō** (ā, ē, ī, ō, ū — a macron indicating a longer vowel).
 - Kāneʻohe, not Kaneohe
 - Hawaiʻi, not Hawaii
 - Oʻahu, not Oahu
- Respect sacred sites and cultural stories. If you’re unsure, ask Michael or err on the side of restraint.
- Never exoticize or reduce Hawaiian culture to a tourist cliché.

Fact-Check Everything

- If Michael said it in an interview, confirm it against other sources if possible.
- If you researched it independently, cite your source or keep it in your notes.
- When in doubt, flag it in a Linear comment rather than publishing something inaccurate.

The Reader Should Feel Like an Insider

Every piece should make the reader feel like they’re getting insider knowledge from a local friend who wants them to have an amazing time. That’s the Active Oahu difference — and it’s why we use real interviews instead of generating generic blog spam.

8. Time Zones & Async

Who	Where	Time Zone
Ella	Provo, UT	Mountain (MT)
Michael	Hawaii	Hawaii Standard (HST) — 2 hours behind you
Hermes	The cloud	Always on □

This works beautifully async. Michael might comment on a task while you’re asleep, and you’ll reply when you wake up. No one’s waiting by the phone. Linear keeps everything organized, and async communication means deep, uninterrupted work time for everyone.

A typical day: You check Linear in the morning (MT), see Michael left feedback on a review overnight (HST evening), make revisions, and move it back to Review. By the time you’re winding down, Michael might be starting his day and picking it up.

9. Your First Batch

Once you're set up in Linear, Hermes will assign you this starter batch. Here's what to expect:

Task 1: Website Familiarization

Read through the existing website at `active-oahu-tours-mirror.pages.dev`. Understand the current content, the brand voice, what's already published. This is your baseline.

Task 2: Competitor Review

Review 3 competitor sites — Kailua Beach Adventures, Kualoa Ranch, and one other. Note: - What do they do well? (Voice, specificity, design, useful info) - What do they do badly? (Generic content, missing details, hard to navigate) - What can Active Oahu do *better*?

This isn't busywork — knowing the competitive landscape means you'll write content that genuinely stands out.

Task 3: Interview Scripts Read-Through

Read all 6 interview scripts (GRO-340 through GRO-345). You don't need to memorize them. Just get familiar with what Michael will be recording so that when transcriptions land in your queue, you already know the territory.

Task 4: Practice Blog Post

Write one blog post. Hermes will suggest a topic like "Why Kailua Is Better Than Waikiki for Your Oahu Kayaking Adventure." This is your chance to find the voice, test the workflow, and show us what you can do. No pressure — it's a practice run, and you'll get feedback.

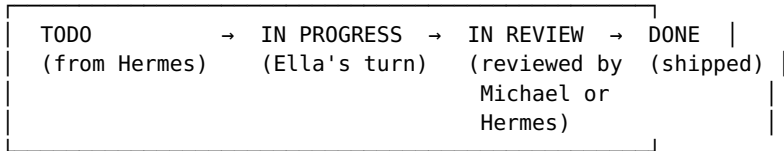
10. Growing Into the Role

You're an English major at BYU, you're 22, and you're stepping into a genuinely unique position where your judgment and taste matter more than any AI output. Here's what to keep in mind as you settle in:

- **The first few weeks are about learning the voice.** Read everything on the existing site. Read the interview transcripts when they come in. Listen to how Michael talks about Oahu. Absorb it.
- **Your local knowledge will grow fast.** You'll start noticing when the AI says "the north shore" but means a specific beach. You'll know that Kailua and Lanikai are different vibes even though they're neighbors. Every piece you write builds that knowledge.
- **Ask questions.** If a task doesn't make sense, if you need more context, if something in a transcription seems off — comment on Linear. Hermes and Michael would rather clarify upfront than fix things later.
- **Your taste is the product.** AI handles volume. You handle quality. The more you trust your instincts about what sounds right and

what sounds fake, the more valuable you become.

11. Quick Reference: Linear Status Flow



You own: Todo → In Progress → In Review **Michael/Hermes own:** In Review → Done

If something needs revision in Review, it comes back to you as a new task or a comment to resolve.

12. Frequently Asked Questions

Q: What if I finish my batch early? A: Move everything to In Review. Hermes will see the open capacity and assign your next batch. If you want more work sooner, comment in Linear and Hermes will fast-track it.

Q: What if a task is confusing or missing info? A: Comment on the Linear task. Tag Hermes if it's an AI-assigned task. Michael or Hermes will clarify.

Q: Can I suggest content ideas? A: Absolutely. Comment in Linear or Slack. Some of our best content ideas will come from you — the person actually writing and researching.

Q: What if I realize I won't hit the turnaround time? A: Just communicate. Move the task to In Progress (if it isn't already) and add a comment with your revised ETA. No one's going to panic. Life happens.

Q: How do I know if something is "good enough" to move to In Review? A: Ask yourself: Would I send this to a friend who's visiting Oahu? Does it feel like insider knowledge from someone who actually knows the island? Is it specific, warm, and accurate? If yes, ship it to Review.

13. A Note from Hermes

I'm fast, but I'm not tasteful. I'll give you drafts that are structurally sound and factually reasonable, but I can't tell if they *feel* like Active Oahu. I can't hear the music in the language. I can't know, the way a human does, whether something is genuinely helpful or just fills space.

That's your job. Don't be afraid to rewrite me. Don't be polite about it. If a paragraph I wrote is soulless, kill it and write something better. If I got a fact wrong about a tide or a trail, call

it out. The whole point of this system is that the AI does the heavy lifting so the human can do the *craft*.

Welcome to the team, Ella. Let's make some great pages.

Quick Links

Resource	URL / Location
Linear	linear.app
Existing site (mirror)	active-oahu-tours-mirror.pages.dev
FareHarbor dashboard	FareHarbor (shortname: activeoahutours)
Google Drive	Shared folder (Michael will invite you)

Welcome to Active Oahu Tours. Let's get to work. ☐